A GOOD GMAT SCORE, BUT AN UNCONVINCING MBA APPLICATION

CASE STUDY STRATEGY WORKSHEET: KARAN MALHOTRA | GMAT PREPARATION

1. Student Persona & Challenge Diagnostic Audit

Candidate: Karan Malhotra | Profile: Finance professional, 5 years of experience, targeting competitive US MBA programmes.. This worksheet outlines the systematic forensic diagnostic and strategic intervention designed to resolve this admissions roadblock.

Assessment Dimension	Diagnostic Finding & Initial Challenge	Strategic Objective
Candidate Profile	Finance professional, 5 years of experience, targeting competitive US MBA programmes.	Build differentiated application proposition
Core Admissions Roadblock	Karan had invested considerable effort in his GMAT preparation and felt ready to apply. However, when he began working on his applications, ...	Eliminate systemic bottlenecks through data feedback
Root Cause Identified	Misalignment between effort and strategic execution	Shift from generic repetition to targeted intervention
Admissions Target	Competitive Global / Indian MBA Program	Maximize admit ROI and scholarship potential

Key Diagnostic Insight:

"A high test score or strong resume alone is not a substitute for a coherent admissions story. Every applicant requires a personalized roadmap that aligns quantitative readiness with distinctive leadership impact." — Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee)

2. Step-by-Step Strategic Intervention

- The mentor shifted the discussion from test scores to the broader admissions proposition.
- Evaluated academics, work experience and career progression.
- Identified measurable professional contributions.
- Examined leadership opportunities beyond formal job titles.
- Mapped short-term and long-term career goals.

3. Actionable Checklist for MBA Applicants

- Diagnostic First: Never increase preparation hours or rewrite essays without an objective diagnostic baseline.
- Data-Driven Tracking: Use targeted analytics to monitor error patterns rather than counting raw study hours.
- Holistic Narrative: Connect undergraduate background, career progression, and MBA goals into one cohesive arc.
- Expert Perspective: Involve senior mentors early to eliminate blind spots and stress-test interview responses.
- Advice: A preparation strategy must fit your reality. Consistency always beats sporadic marathons.

Already have a competitive GMAT score? Get your MBA profile evaluated before choosing business schools.

Schedule a 1-on-1 strategy session with Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee) at www.mbawizards.co.in